

I don't quite believe in asking people to put 30 per cent into one category or 20 per cent in another. Value-based spending means you get to decide what you do with the money you get in your account every week. You may decide to put 50 per cent into your living costs because you prefer to live in a more expensive city to be close to family — that doesn't mean you should be made to feel guilty for not keeping living expenses 'under 30 per cent'. It's all about aligning what's on this paper with what you value in your life.

Once you get a clear picture on that you'll know exactly what you have left to allocate to investing. Someone may say 'This leaves me with \$50 left over at the end of the week, but I value holidays so I'm okay with putting \$40 of that money into a savings account towards my travel fund, and putting \$10 to investing.' That is fine.

You are allowed to decide that travelling means more to you than investing. We are not all the same people, and we have different life experiences and desires. It's just important to note that we can't have it all at the same time; if we want to grow our wealth faster, it's about deciding what our values are and shifting our spending and saving habits to reflect that. One person is going to feel more fulfilled by being wealthy in experiences over money. It's too personal to generalise and shame each other on our money habits.

By having a clearer idea of where your money is going, you get to control it rather than having it control you.

Your spending habits are not an easy thing to face, but you're better off in the long term to have laid down this brick. Well done.

Brick #2: Tackle high-interest debt

Trying to invest while having high-interest debt is like trying to fill a bucket with a hole in it. No matter how much water you put in, whether it be from a glass or water directly from a hose, you will never be able to fill the bucket until you block the hole that's draining your wealth ... I mean water. See [figure 3.2](#).